

CREATIVITY AND STORYTELLING

One aspect of how a social media brand will pull in more users (especially kids) is by using technology creatively. A simple example is FaceApp's gender changing filter thing. Just that one innovation earned it so much publicity, including negative publicity about it being owned and run by the KGB who were making a database of people from across the planet as a way of infiltrating spies by replacing those people with lookalikes... or whatever conspiracy theory you heard...

Kids gravitate towards creativity and being given an easy way to express themselves creatively. This isn't just a question of filters and technology, but also being given more freedom to tell their own stories in their own way. While 99.9% of videos on TikTok are just people copying others, the 0.1% of people who innovate and pioneer new trends on that platform and others like it are downright geniuses! There are surely some budding filmmakers of the future on these platforms, and they will get to follow their passion thanks to being given the opportunity and recognition they deserve.



Facebook is aggressively researching AR technologies.

With monetisation for the stuff people do, social media is not just fun anymore either, as there are millions of dollars waiting to be made by the most creative and good-looking people out there. This is also a negative for larger networks, because it leaves most of their users unfulfilled. Users might flock to smaller more niche platforms just to be a much bigger fish in a much smaller pond, instead of being just an average fish in the lake or sea that the behemoth networks are.

There's also a question of recognition from peers. Getting very positive feedback about that picture you clicked from friends and family is nice, but getting professional photographers compliment you on the same picture in a dedicated group meant for them will send you to cloud nine!

AR AND VR

For us, these are going to be the biggest disruptors to the whole social media game. In fact, these will make social media into a real life game. Remember Pokemon Go and how crazy some kids got for it? Imagine a much more enhanced experience where you can literally see informa-

tion about people that they want to make public, in real time, as you walk by them. Not just people, imagine the same being done for places, and you being able to bring up reviews about a restaurant in real-time, and not just reviews from random strangers on the internet, but from those on your friends list who have visited here. The same for products you're looking at.... The possibilities are endless once the technology catches up to our imagination, and it will. Things like Google Glass were way ahead of their time, but their time will come again. Some company or the other will innovate in this space and change the way we socialise permanently, and we honestly believe that if not this change being AR or VR, it will be something else that happens as Gen C grows up that will make any new social network of their age look totally alien to us today.

DATING

No one wants to think of their tiny newborn as a creature that seeks emotional and sexual satisfaction from others, but let's face it, that's just a human condition none of us can avoid. Little Gen C babies will be ready to date in about 15 years time, and any social network of the time will also enable this to happen. As the opportunities to meet new people IRL shrink into nothing thanks to ridiculous schedules. Already teenagers believe that dating only amongst the people you meet in school or through friends seems a lot like settling for mediocrity. It's the whole reason why online dating is so popular amongst singles, and this is not really something that ever changes drastically over the years. And when we say years, we mean the hundred thousand years our species has walked this planet...

In the end, all we humans seek is a way to connect, and we don't mean to date or fall in love, because that section is over. We're now talking about the basic human need to socialise and share interests and learn from one another. These are all the very basic requisites of any social network of the future, and not just for Gen C kids. All that will change is the way we meet that need, and what platform and methods we use to connect to one another. We've given you our thoughts about the future and stuck our necks out. Why don't you do the same and write in and tell us what the future of social networking looks like to you? If that sounds too complicated, just write in and tell us about features you wish the social networks of today seem to be lacking, or technologies you wish were invented.

The most creative ideas will win some exciting mystery prizes. Drop us a line at feedback@digit.in or join our Telegram group (t.me/digitgeek), or you can WhatsApp (<http://digit.in/WhatsApp>) us as well. 

Suggested reading / watching

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